

LastOne_Social_Architecture_TBC

Working Decisions Record

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What this document is

This is the working decisions record for LastOne's social architecture. It captures what the social layer is, how each feature works, and the reasoning behind every decision. It is not a design spec, but it is written so that a design spec can be built directly on top of it. Someone picking this up without prior context should be able to understand the full picture.

Section 1 — Why the social layer exists

Smoking is a social behaviour. For Indian college students, it is woven into the fabric of how people connect — the chai break between lectures, the tapri after an exam, the cigarette shared with friends at the end of a long day. Quitting in isolation while everyone around you keeps smoking is one of the primary reasons quit attempts fail.

The social layer exists to keep quitting from feeling lonely. It does not try to replace the social ritual of smoking. It tries to give the user a sense that quitting is a shared experience rather than a solo opt-out from their existing social world.

The social layer has two components: Quit Groups and the Community Feed. A third component, Nearby Quitters, was considered and scrapped. That decision is documented in Section 4.

Section 2 — Layer 1: Quit Groups

What it is and what it's for

A Quit Group is a small group of 2–6 people the user already knows, brought together inside the app around a shared quitting journey. The feature exists to serve two specific needs: making the user feel less alone in the journey, and making quitting feel like a shared decision rather than one person opting out while everyone else stays in.

The group is not a crisis support tool. It is not a traditional accountability mechanism. It is a shared space that makes the journey feel less solitary.

Group structure

Groups are created by any member at any stage. Invites are sent via shareable link — WhatsApp, SMS, or copy. Each member keeps their own individual stage, streak, and progress. The group has a founding date set by the creator that cannot be backdated and never resets, even if individual members relapse and restart.

What gets shared

Milestone sharing Decision: when a user hits a health or streak milestone, they are asked if they want to share it with the group. If yes, it appears in the group dashboard and members are notified. If no, nothing is sent. **Why:** milestones are the safest shared moment — they are unambiguously positive, carry no risk of demoralising other members, and reinforce the sense of collective progress without exposing personal struggle.

Coping activity signal Decision: when a user completes a coping tool, a lightweight signal can be sent to the group — "[Name] just used the breathing tool." Craving detail is never included. **Why:** the signal tells the group someone is actively

managing a hard moment without exposing what triggered it or how severe it was. It invites support without requiring vulnerability.

Info card sharing Decision: if a user finds a reframing card or content piece genuinely helpful, they can share it directly to the group. **Why:** this is the lowest-risk shared moment — it is not personal data, it does not expose struggle, and it gives the group something actionable. It also reinforces the value of the app's content layer within the social layer.

Weekly reflection Decision: every Sunday, a single question is sent to the group — "What was the hardest moment this week?" Each member answers privately. Once answered, their response becomes visible to the group. Members who do not answer are not pressured. The prompt disappears after 48 hours. **Why:** the weekly cadence creates a low-pressure shared ritual. Answers only become visible after the member submits their own — this removes the performance pressure of responding to what others have already said, and creates genuine shared vulnerability rather than one-sided disclosure.

What is not shared

Decision: craving detail, slip counts, and relapse information are never shared automatically. Individual streaks are not visible to other group members. The SOS function does not connect to the group. **Why:** craving detail and slip information carry the highest risk of creating shame or enabling relapse. Streak comparisons between members create unhealthy pressure — seeing a friend's streak reset can create a permission effect ("if they slipped, I can too") as easily as it creates motivation. SOS is removed from the group entirely because human response during a craving moment is unpredictable — the wrong response from a friend can do active harm, and the app has no way to control what people say to each other.

Working hypothesis and open questions

The interaction model for day-to-day group life is still being defined. Two user interviews have been conducted and pointed in opposite directions — one person wanted external accountability and physical intervention, the other wanted emotional presence and empathy with no advice-giving. This gap means we cannot yet design a single interaction model that serves both needs reliably.

The shaming risk is also unresolved. A friend group's natural response when someone is wavering is often counterproductive. If the app prompts friends to engage during hard moments, it cannot control how they engage. This may be a human behaviour problem that features alone cannot solve.

This feature is benched for MVP. It will be revisited once more interview data is available — specifically, at least one person who quit successfully with social support around them, and one who quit completely alone.

Section 3 — Community Feed

What it is and what it's for

The Community Feed is a shared space open to the entire LastOne community. It exists for one primary reason: to show users that quitting is survivable and that people like them have done it. Early-stage users read it to feel less alone before they have anything to share. Later-stage users become contributors — their lived experience is genuinely useful to people just starting out.

The feed is not a social platform. There are no follower counts, no like counts, no public metrics of any kind. It is not designed for performance or competition. It is designed for togetherness.

Access

Decision: the feed is locked until Stage 3. Users in Stages 0–2 do not see it, not even in read-only mode. Returning users — those on a second or later quit attempt — retain full access regardless of their current stage. **Why:** early-stage users are in the most vulnerable window. The feed's content, even well-intentioned, can destabilise someone who hasn't yet found their footing. Locking returning users out contradicts the core principle that restarts reset the timeline, not the relationship with the app.

Post types

Four types: milestone (a win — a day count, a health recovery moment, a personal breakthrough), reflection (freeform — what happened, how it felt, what helped), question (asking the community for help or perspective), and encouragement (a general shoutout, not attached to a specific person).

Sort order

Decision: the feed sorts by post type and reader stage, not chronologically. Milestones and encouragement surface first. Reflections and questions come after. Time is a tiebreaker within each category. **Why:** chronological sort means the most recent post surfaces first regardless of content — which in practice means the most emotionally raw posts are the first thing a user sees. Sorting by type and stage ensures the feed opens with stable, forward-looking content.

Pre-composer friction

Decision: before the composer opens, the user is asked one question — "How are you feeling right now?" — with three options: good, okay, struggling. If they select struggling, a framing note appears before they write: something like "it's okay to share this — just know your words might reach someone who's having a hard day too." This is not a gate. It does not block posting. **Why:** people in a low state are the most likely to post something that lands badly for others. The mood check adds a moment of self-reflection and asks the user to hold their reader in mind. The framing note is not punitive — it acknowledges their state while gently broadening their perspective.

Publishing delay

Decision: there is a short delay between a post being submitted and it going live in the feed. Duration TBD with the team — in the range of 5–10 minutes. **Why:** raw emotional posts written in a passing moment of weakness go live immediately without this. The delay gives the user a window to pull it back if they feel differently a few minutes later.

Reactions

Decision: four fixed reactions, supportive only, no counts shown publicly. I hear you — empathy. I feel this — solidarity. You've got this — encouragement. This helped me — practical value. No negative reactions. **Why:** public counts create performance incentive and social comparison. Removing them keeps the focus on

connection rather than validation. Supportive-only reactions mean the feed cannot be used to pile on or shame.

Reply structure

Decision: two levels only — posts and replies. No threading. No @ functionality. Replies are addressed to the original poster only, not to other commenters. **Why:** threading and @ functionality enable two users to go back and forth directly, which can become a spiral between two vulnerable people that neither would have entered alone. Removing these keeps replies as individual responses to the original post, not conversations between commenters.

Harmful content handling

Decision: every post passes through an auto-filter before going live. Hard-blocked terms — medication names and similar — are rejected with a notification to the user to edit and resubmit. The filter is intentionally lenient on casual language. Any user can report any post. Three unique reports triggers auto-hide and entry into a moderation queue. The LastOne team reviews and either restores or removes permanently. The poster is notified either way. Tone and framing problems that are not keyword-filterable are accepted as residual risk, managed through the combination of sort order, publishing delay, pre-composer framing nudge, and the report function. **Why:** a strict filter would block legitimate emotional expression from an audience that communicates casually. The three-report threshold protects vulnerable users during the gap between flagging and human review without requiring a single person's judgment to take content down. Residual risk from non-keyword harmful content is accepted because the alternative — aggressive tone detection — would over-apply and create a feed that feels over-managed and inauthentic.

Nudge system

Decision: nudges fire on milestone hits and streak milestones only. Framing is an invitation to reflect — "You just hit 30 days. What's one thing you know now that you didn't at the start?" — not a call to contribute. Delivered as a push notification timed to the user's known low-risk windows from Learning Week data. Decay: three ignores drops to pop-up only, six to home screen card only, nine stops entirely. One post resets to full volume. **Why:** craving overcome was removed as a trigger because relief and stability are not the same state — content written immediately after resisting a craving is less likely to be useful to others. The reflective framing avoids creating obligation or guilt for not posting. Timed delivery ensures the nudge doesn't arrive during a high-risk window when the user is least equipped to engage with it thoughtfully. The decay system respects the user's implicit signal without going permanently silent.

Section 4 — What we scrapped and why

Layer 2: Nearby Quitters

Scrapped. The problem this layer was trying to solve was never clearly defined. Proximity to another quitter does not reliably provide the kind of support that helps someone stay quit. The relapse-enabling risk — two people in a high-craving state, physically near each other, connected through an app about smoking — is real and has no reliable guardrail. The privacy concern is also significant: quitting smoking in

an Indian college context implicitly announces that you were a smoker and that you're struggling, which many users will not want people in their physical vicinity to know. The feature is parked indefinitely.

SOS-to-group

Scrapped. Human response during a craving moment is unpredictable. Interview data confirmed that on a genuinely bad day, nothing another person says helps — and the wrong response from a friend can do active harm. The SOS flow stays self-contained within the coping tools, where the outcome is reliable.

"Fighting together for X days" counter

Scrapped as designed. A number that only goes up regardless of individual behaviour creates no real accountability and becomes meaningless after the first week. A replacement has not been designed yet — this is an open question that will be resolved when the Quit Groups feature is revisited post-MVP.